## MMSU's Commitment

***Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.***

**SDG 15.2.5 · Sustainable management of land for agriculture (educational outreach)**

*Offer educational programme/outreach for local or national communities on sustainable management of land for agriculture.*

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

# School-on-the-Air Brings Regenerative Vegetable Farming to 1,000 Ilocanos




*MMSU School-on-the-Air (Eskuela iti Tangatang) season on regenerative vegetable farming, June–December 2025. (Image: MMSU)*

A new season of the MMSU School-on-the-Air (SOA), the university's radio-based educational program, opened on June 24 and 25, 2025 with 1,000 enrollees from the 22 municipalities and cities of Ilocos Norte. The season focused on regenerative vegetable farming for enhanced and sustainable production, with lessons on climate-smart practices and off-season vegetable seeding.

Vegetable growers, rural improvement club members, agricultural extension workers and students followed the lessons, broadcast from June to December 2025 over DWFB Radyo Pilipinas Laoag, DWCI Radyo Adjo Piddig and DWNI Radyo Karruba Burgos. MMSU ran the program with the

Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, the Office of the Provincial Agriculturist, local government units, the Ilocos Agriculture, Aquatic and Natural Resources Research and Development Consortium, and the High-Value Crops Division of Ilocos Norte.

**Source**

- MMSU News, "MMSU draws 1K enrollees for SOA program on sustainable vegetable farming," 26 June 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-draws-1k-enrollees-for-soa-program-on-sustainable-vegetable-farming

## Bamboo Propagation and Plantation Management Training in Pinili



*Participants of the bamboo propagation, nursery and plantation management training, Brgy. Aglipay, Pinili, 2025. (Photo: MMSU)*

The MMSU Extension Directorate and the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development, in partnership with Barangay Aglipay, Pinili, Ilocos Norte, and with the support of the Ilocos Agriculture, Aquatic and Natural Resources Research and Development Consortium (ILAARRDEC), conducted a two-day training on bamboo production in 2025.

The training equipped 46 farmers, local leaders and community members with practical skills in bamboo propagation, nursery establishment and plantation management. Lectures covered the prospects of the bamboo industry and MMSU's propagation methods, and participants helped establish a new bambusetum, a collection of bamboo species, in Barangay Aglipay. Lectures and demonstrations were given by bamboo experts Mr. Charlie Maine Cacactin of CAFSD and Mr. Bonne Jovie Orteza of MMSU. Pinili Municipal Agriculturist Philip Galang, representing Mayor Rommel T. Labasan, thanked MMSU and ILAARRDEC, and the project was championed in the community by Pinili's Magsasaka Siyentista, Mr. Reynaldo Antalan.

**Source**

- MMSU News, "Sustainable livelihood: MMSU, ILAARRDEC hold bamboo training in Pinili," 3 September 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/sustainable-livelihood-mmsu-ilaarrdec-hold-bamboo-training-in-pinili

# President's Farm Field Day Showcases Climate-Resilient Rice Varieties




*President's Farm technology demonstration of inbred and hybrid rice varieties, 28 October 2025. (Photo: MMSU)*




*Farmers, LGU technicians and students at the President's Farm Field Day, in front of CAFSD. (Photo: MMSU)*

On October 28, 2025, the MMSU Extension Directorate, with the Philippine Rice Research Institute (PhilRice) Batac Branch, held the President's Farm Field Day: A Technology Showcase in front of the College of Agriculture, Food and Sustainable Development. Farmers and farmer-leaders, agricultural technicians from Ilocos Norte local government units, BS Agriculture students, and MMSU and PhilRice rice specialists viewed eight rice varieties grown under wet-season conditions.

The varieties included four newly released by PhilRice, two public hybrids, and two suited to saline and rainfed conditions, among them NSIC Rc 686 (Salinas 39) and NSIC Rc 650 (Sahod Ulan 36), giving farmers options for saline-affected and rainfed fields. Speakers included MMSU President Dr. Virgilio Julius P. Manzano Jr., Extension Director Dr. Marlowe Aquino, and former MMSU President and PhilRice Executive Director Dr. Santiago R. Obien.

**Source**

- MMSU News, "MMSU President's Farm showcases 8 rice varieties," 4 November 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2665/mmsu-presidents-farm-showcases-8-rice-varieties

# Farmers in Sarrat Trained to Propagate the Indigenous Alukon




*Farmers and local officials trained on alukon (himbabao) propagation, Brgy. 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, 2 May 2025. (Photo: MMSU)*

On May 2, 2025, the MMSU Research and Extension Directorates trained 64 farmers in Barangay 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, Ilocos Norte, on the propagation of alukon (himbabao), a Philippine indigenous vegetable tree. Barangay officials, members of the Task Force Dagger Special Operations Foundation and representatives of the local government unit also attended. The training was held in response to requests from the community.

Resource speakers Dr. Menisa Antonio, Engr. Josefa Pugat and Mr. Jayson Rasay of the Research Directorate presented recommended propagation strategies to establish sustained alukon production in the community and broaden the use of the crop for food and other applications.

**Source**

- MMSU News, “MMSU trains Sarrat farmers on alukon propagation,” 9 May 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-trains-sarrat-farmers-on-alukon-propagation